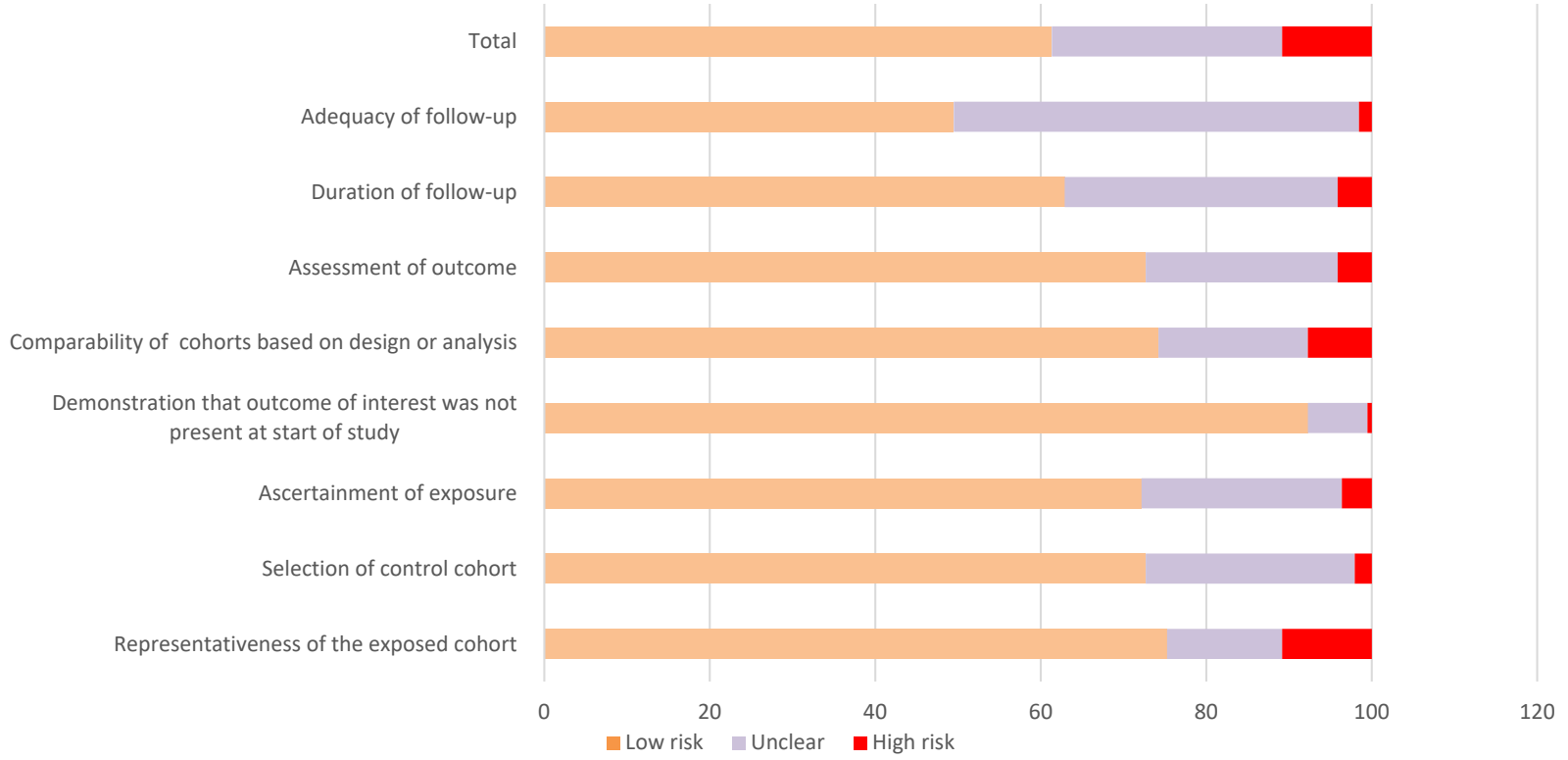
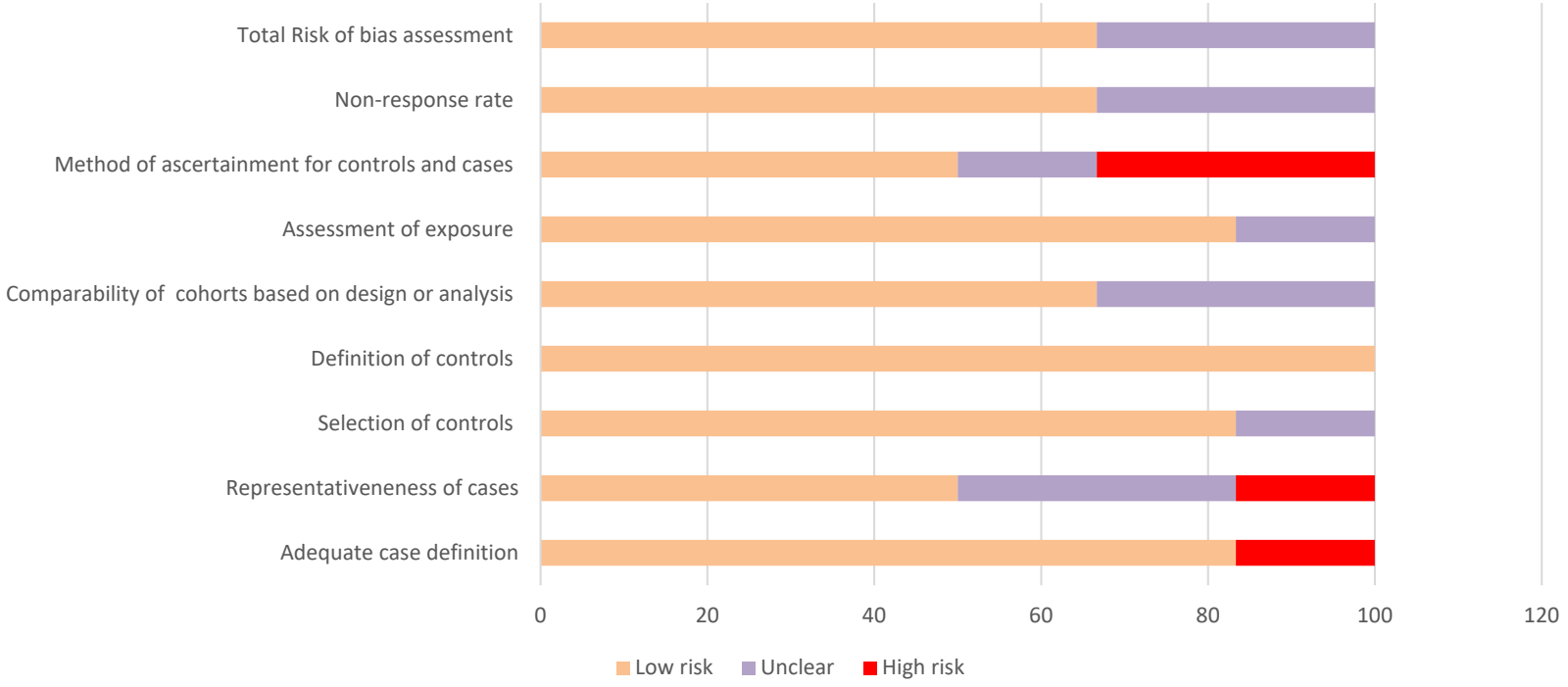
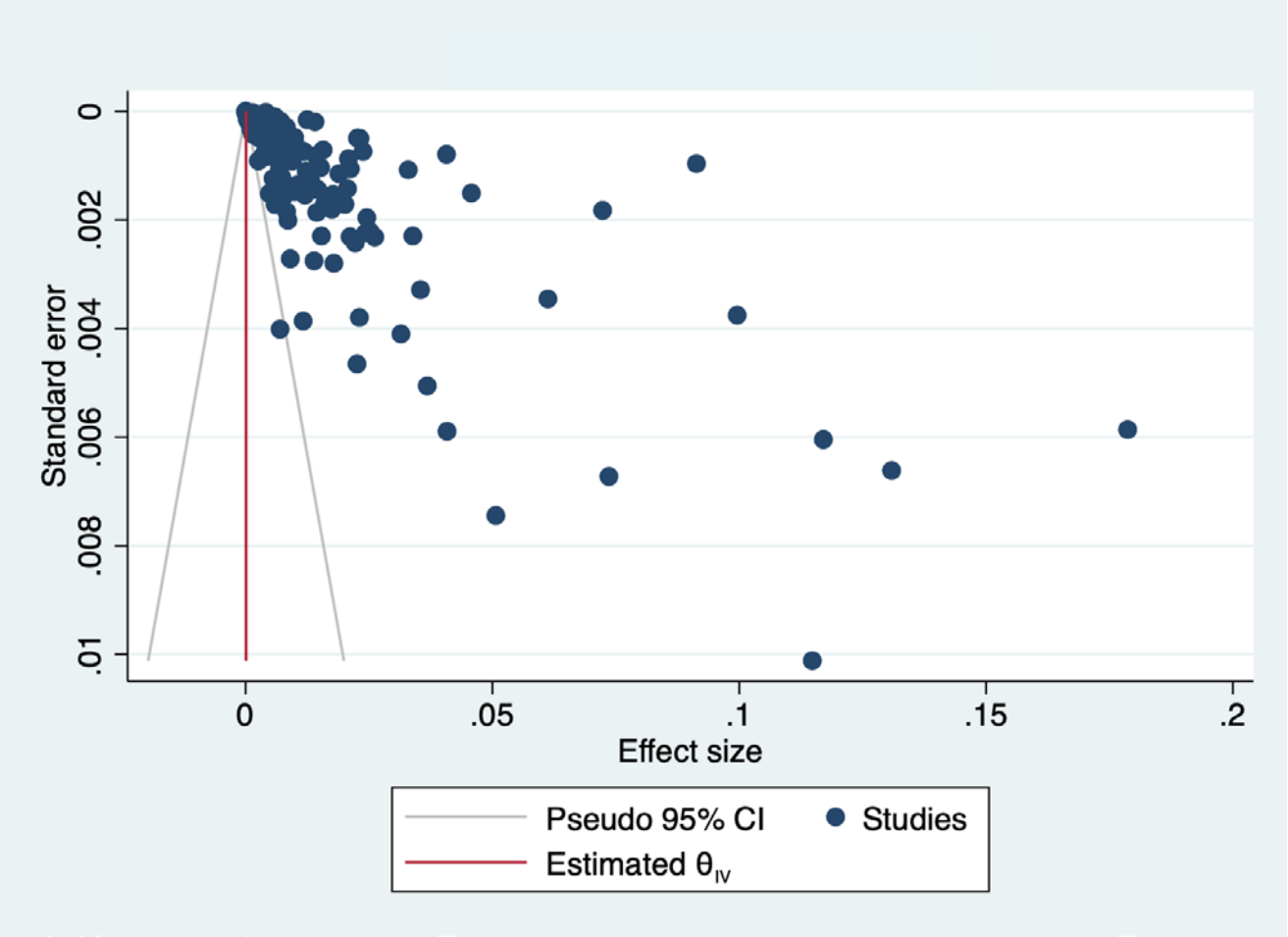
Supplementary Figure 1A. Risk of Bias for Cohort Studies (n=192)



Supplementary Figure 1B. Risk of Bias for case control studies (n=6)



Supplementary Figure 2. Funnel Plot



Supplementary Table 1. Included studies.

Western Pacific (n=4)	
Papua New Guinea (n=3)	Hamura (2013); Tanimia (2016); Bolnga (2017).
Timor Leste (n=1)	Jayaratnam (2019).
South Asia (n=95)	
Bangladesh (n=11)	Begum (1993); Chowdhury (2000); Khanam (2001); Chakraborty (2003); Ferdous (2012); Huda (2012); Kim (2012); Parna (2013); Sikder (2014); Nahar (2017); Sharmin (2019).
India (n=50)	Trivedi (1968); Jain (1988); Bhatia (1996); Sarkar (1996); Rashmi (2001); Thakur (2001); Chhabra (2002); Bang (2004); Kaul (2006); Prakash (2006); Chatterjee (2007); Seal (2007); Tempe (2007); Shirazee (2010); Gupta (2011); Nanjundan (2011); Iyengar (2012); Korejo (2012); Veena (2012); Ps (2013); Ashraf (2014); Kalra (2014); Nachuraju (2014); Pandey (2014); Purandare (2014); Chalwa (2015); Dambal (2015); Sangeeta (2015); Abha (2016); Jain (2016); Kulkarni (2016); Parmar (2016); Rathod (2016); Sinha (2016); Vaishnav (2016); Dasgupta (2017); Khan (2017); Marwah (2017); Murki (2017); Sharma (2017); Singla (2017); Tahmina (2017); Panda (2018); Prakash (2018); Chhabra (2019); Mansuri (2019); Sailaja (2019); Vanukuru (2019); Vousden (2019); Ganvir (2020).
Nepal (n=10)	Choudhary (2003); Padhye (2005); Chuni (2006); Mishra (2006); Pradhan (2006); Srestha (2010); Rana (2013); Ghimire (2016); Srestha (2017); Rana (2018).
Pakistan (n=23)	Hassan (1991); Khan (1993); Hassan (1993); Jamelle (1998); Shaheen (2003); Naib (2004); Mustafa (2009); Nisar (2009); Halimi (2010); Saeed (2010); Shamshad (2010); Fatima (2011); Rizwan (2011a); Rizwan (2011b); Siddiqui (2012); Sultana (2012); Qazi (2012); Mazhar (2015); Ali (2018); Islam (2018); Chen (2019); Duan (2019); Sultana (2019).
India & Pakistan (n=1)	Goldenberg (2017)
Southeast Asia (n=28)	
Cambodia (n=1)	Koum (2004).
Indonesia (n=3)	Adisamita (2008); Ronsmans (2009); Adisamita (2015).
Laos (n=1)	Luexay (2014).
Malaysia (n=4)	Ong (1978); Rachagan (1991); Sivalingam (1999); Norhayati (2016).
Philippines (n=1)	Acosta Sison (1953).
Singapore (n=7)	Cheng (1971); Chew (1984); Chua (1988); Ng (1992); Chen (1995); Low (1995); Chen (2003).
Thailand (n=11)	Chumnijarakj (1974); Porapakkham (1979); Suchartwatnachai (1991); Roungsipragarn (1993); Booriboonhirunsarn (1996); Kovavisarach (2006); Pitaphrom (2006); Watanasomsiri (2006); Liabsuetrakul (2008); Yamasmit (2009); Kongwattanakul (2018).
Northeast Asia (n=12)	
Japan (n=4)	Yamamoto (2000); Morikawa (2012); Katoaka (2018); Makino (2019).
Korea (n=3)	Cho (2013); Nam (2019a); Nam (2019b).
Taiwan (n-5)	Ding (2006); Jou (2008); Tang (2009); Lau (2010); Wu (2017).
China and Hong Kong (n=18)	

China (n=14)	Tang (1997); Shen (2013); Wang (2013); Pradhan (2014); Wei (2014); Shen (2015); Liang (2017); Yuqi (2017); Yang (2018); Zhao (2018); Lin (2019); Mu (2019); Ma (2020); Zhang (2020).
Hong Kong (n=4)	Lao (1987); Lau (1997); Wong (1999); Ng (2014).
Australia and New Zealand (n=32)	
Australia (n=25)	St George (1990); Stephens (1991); Cincotta (1996); Lynch (1996); Roberts (2008); Sriram (2008); Roberts (2009); Roberts (2010); Awan (2011); Jayaratnam (2011); Laws (2014); Lim (2014); Paxton (2014); Lindquist (2015); Shamsa (2015); Urquia (2015); Cheng (2016); Jayaratnam (2016); Jayaratnam (2018); Fitzpatrick (2019); Lipkind (2019); Jayawardena (2019); Davey (2020); Duke (2020); Jayaratnam (2020).
New Zealand (n=6)	Wong (2011); Sadler (2013); Lepine (2018); Lawton (2019); MacDonald (2019); Chang (2020).
Australia and New Zealand (n=1)	McDonnell (2015).
Central Asia (n=1)	
Afghanistan (n=1)	Kim (2013)
Western Asia (n=6)	
Iraq (n=2)	Jabir (2013); Akrawi (2017).
Kuwait (n=1)	Makhseed (1996).
Saudi Arabia (n=1)	Jabbar (1980).
Syria (n=1)	Almeria (2010).
United Arab Emirates (n=1)	Ghazal-Aswad (2013).
>1 Region – including Central Asia; Western Asia; South Asia; Southeast Asia; China and Hong Kong and Northeast Asia (n=1)	
Includes Afghanistan, Pakistan, India, Nepal, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Cambodia, China, Japan, Mongolia, Philippines and Vietnam (n=1)	Abalos (2014).

Supplementary Table 2. Near miss by country and sub-region, economic status and health care setting

Sub-region/country	Total near miss	Total births
Western Pacific	387	35,956
South Asia	15,373	2,012,398
South-East Asia	4,410	1,824,098
North East Asia	7,802	8,413,781
China and Hong Kong	50,609	10,040,000
Australia and New Zealand	17,236	6,880,552
Central Asia	712	132,898
Western Asia	2,243	388,760
>1 sub-region *	476	124,481
Economic status		
Low income	1,678	189,224
Lower middle income	16,804	2,200,770
Upper middle income	52,761	11,200,000
High income	28,005	16,600,000
Hospital Setting		
Tertiary referral hospital	33,914	7,491,507
Secondary hospital	117	285,94
Community/peripheral health centre	4,048	1632,95
Nation-wide or state-wide database	19,045	11,500.000
Combined	42,124	11,000,000
TOTAL	**98,248**	**29,852,924**

***Abalos 2014**

Supplementary Table 3. Near miss frequencies and total births by definition

Sub-region/country	Total near miss	Total births
WHO Near Miss	47521	10048175
Other criteria	27937	2852707
Severe maternal complication/disease specific	74726	26221627
Management specific	21874	7795184